

Mareike Focken

AI & DEVELOPMENT CONSULTANT | SOFTWARE & WEB DEVELOPMENT



PROFILE

I connect people, ideas and technology. As an AI and development consultant, I help companies identify productive uses for AI, develop web and software solutions, increasingly through AI-assisted workflows, and enable teams to use AI productively on their own. My background combines computer science (MSc, grade 1.0), linguistics and information science (MA, grade 1.1), and many years of experience bridging domain needs and software development.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Consultant – AI & Development

since 05/2026 | ProcuVia AG, Düsseldorf

- Advise clients on AI applications and develop solutions from requirements analysis through implementation
- Gather requirements in on-site client meetings and translate business needs into clear specifications for development
- Develop internal AI tools, extract information from unstructured data and support colleagues in adopting AI; use AI-assisted workflows in line with clean code principles

Research Associate – Web Development & E-Learning

2021 – 2025 | Hochschule Düsseldorf – University of Applied Sciences

- **Project CoCre-HIT (2024 – 2025):** Led the development team; designed and built a digital knowledge platform for participatory technology development in healthcare (MVP: cocre-hit.de/kompendium; React, TypeScript, CI/CD)
- Coordinated teams across universities, facilitated workshops, conducted requirements analysis and designed the information architecture
- **Project EILD.nrw (2021 – 2023):** Designed, developed and evaluated e-learning modules for database courses (Moodle, H5P, web app)
- Coordinated project work across four universities and developed the project website eild.nrw
- 2020 – 2021: Taught object-oriented programming (Java) to beginners as an academic tutor

CONTACT

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Düsseldorf | Remote

SKILLS

AI & MACHINE LEARNING

AI-assisted software development:
Claude Code, Codex, GitHub Copilot

Daily use of ChatGPT and Claude;
prompt engineering; understanding of
LLM fundamentals

AI enablement and training design

ML/DL in Python (master's thesis):
audio processing, ASR (Whisper), voice
activity detection, source separation,
NLP

DEVELOPMENT

Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Java,
React/Next.js, HTML5, CSS/Tailwind,
SQL, Git, CI/CD

METHODS

Requirements engineering, Scrum and
agile methods, workshop facilitation,
instructional design, information
architecture, UX/UI and prototyping

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Web, Marketing & Event Management

2007 – 2021 | IIK Düsseldorf e. V.

- **Web Design, Relaunch & Content Management (2017 – 2021):**
Managed website content and technical maintenance for the institute. Planned, coordinated and implemented a relaunch using modern technologies and user-centred design (TYPO3, Magento, UX/UI, prototyping), 2018 – 2020. Relaunched iik-deutschland.de, iik-berlin.de and iik-duesseldorf.de in 09/2020
- **Marketing & Graphic Design, Assistant / Acting Head (2015 – 2021):**
Oversaw corporate design and communication materials across print and web throughout the organisation (Adobe Creative Suite); served as acting head from 2018 to 2020
- **Project Lead – Event Management (2007 – 2017):** Independently planned, organised and delivered approximately 250 cultural and recreational events per year, including coordination and financial administration; led a team of 5 to 10 tutors

Tango Argentino Instructor

since 2007 | freelance, including at tanzhaus nrw

- Teach complex movement patterns, non-verbal communication and improvisation to diverse groups

EDUCATION

MSc Media Informatics (part-time)

2019 – 2026 | Hochschule Düsseldorf – University of Applied Sciences | grade 1.0 with distinction

- Master's thesis: "A Data-Driven Audio Processing Pipeline for Isolating Non-Verbal Vocalizations from In-the-Wild Recordings" (ML/audio, Python)
- 2019 – 2023: Completed 90 ECTS of undergraduate computer science in the BSc programme (average grade 1.3), then admitted to the MSc programme

MA Linguistics, Information Science & Modern Japan

2001 – 2009 | Heinrich Heine University Düsseldorf | grade 1.1

- Additional qualification in teaching German as a Foreign Language

LANGUAGES

German – native

English – C1 (CEFR)

French – B2 (CEFR)

Spanish – A2 (CEFR)

Teaching qualification: German as a Foreign Language

PERSONAL STRENGTHS

Strong communication skills, solution-focused, quick to learn

INTERESTS

AI and purposeful digitalisation, Tango Argentino, singing, travel